VOL 113 #6 NOVEMBER-DECEMBER 2008

THE OFFICIAL PUBLICATION OF THE SAN ANTONIO PHILATELIC ASSOCIATION FOUNDED 1896

http://www.virtualstampclub.com/apstexas.html

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388 T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

MEETING CALENDAR

NOVEMBER			DECEMBER		
7	Juniors Board of Governors Meeting Program: 'Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm	5	Juniors Blue Chip Auction Come at 7 to browse	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
14	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm	12	**CHRISTMAS PARTY** ELECTION(set-up at 6:00)	6:30 pm
21	Juniors Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	6:15 pm 7:00 pm	19	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm
28	NO MEETING HAPPY THANKSGIVING		26	NO MEETING MERRY CHRISTMAS	
	December 21 Happy Hanukkah		Jan 2	NO MEETING HAPPY NEW YEAR	
1 /09 - Jrs, BOG, Show & Tell 1/16 - Auction 1/23 - Jrs, Program 1/30 - Bourse					

EDITORS' CORNER

LEA SENGHAAS & DORA ROBERTS

LEA'S TWO BITS WORTH

As you all know, the Nacogdoches and Loop 410 intersection is getting a lot of construction done to it. I have been told that there are also plans to repave Nacogdoches north to Danbury Dr. This means that getting to stamp club meetings by way of Nacogdoches may become very frustrating until they are finished.

To avoid the mess, go around it. You can get to our meetings by going north on Broadway to Bitters, turn right and go east to Nacogdoches, turn right and drive south to Lovelace Blvd, where the church is. Or you can get on the Wurtzbach Parkway, take the Nacogdoches exit and go south to the church.

This may not be necessary yet, but please keep an eye on the construction, and if possible, avoid it. Plan in advance which route you will follow if Nacogdoches gets difficult to travel on. We want everyone to get to club meetings safely.

DORA'S TWO BITS WORTH

For future reference from a membership standpoint—if you have held any office at any time in the past, will you please let me know what and when? Please tell me if you know what year you joined, also. I am trying to update the old club journal, and this would be a big help. Thanks.

we both wish all our friends a wonderful holiday season

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
Philatex Editors
334 Olney Dr.
San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us.
lys@satx.rr.com dora.roberts@hotmail.com

Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Jane K Fohn
Vice President:	Richard Rose
Secretary:	Bro. Ed Loch
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Judith Grant
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneer:	
Librarian:	

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Jane K Fohn
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Bob Joyce
One year term:	Patrick J Ryan
Two year term:	Pat Richmond
Parliamentarian:	Bob Joyce
Honorary Board Member	Richard Spies

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Oklahoma Philatelic Society:	Jane K Fohn
Texas Philatelic Association:	Robert J. Joyce
U.S. Postal Service:	Steve E. Canedo
APS Circuit Books	Patrick J. Ryan
Oklahoma Circuit Books	Jane K Fohn

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities, and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourse, and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE:

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

Please wait until the end of the auction to pay for your purchases. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks are acceptable, made out to S.A.P.A.

Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

Blue Chip Auction - Dec 5, 08

Items will be on display at club meetings starting November 7th. PLEASE LOOK ONLY, DO NOT TOUCH. Ask Jack for help if you need to see an item more closely.

If you have any questions, call 210-826-4826, or come to meeting. To bid: write the lot #, the maximum amount you wish to bid, your name, address, phone, and email (if you have one), and mail your bid to:

SAPA - Jack Virta
2907 Sir Phillip
San Antonio, Tx 78209

Mail-in bids will be accepted up to 7:00 p.m. on auction day.

You will be notified if you win a lot. If you wish to have it mailed to you, it will be sent upon receipt of payment (includes amount of bid, tax, plus postage and insurance). If you wish to make other arrangements to pick-up your purchases, contact Jack Virta at above the address / phone number.

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PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Another giant Texas pat on the back to Pat Richmond for her great work planning interesting programs for 2008! And what's more, she already has programs lined up for 2009. You certainly don't want to miss a thing during the rest of this year, and in next.

Just check this issue of *The Philatex* to see all that is going to happen in November and December. There will be juniors' meetings, show-and-tell, a regular auction, the Blue Chip Auction, bourses, Bag Night material to search through, and a Christmas Party with an election.

Speaking of the election, why don't you volunteer your talents for SAPA? There are a number of things that you may take part in—just ask. Look over the list of our offices and appointments on the inside cover of the *Philatex* and contact Judy Grant, chairwoman of the nominations committee.

Please note that there will be no meetings on the Fridays following Thanksgiving, Christmas, and New Years Day.

This is my last President's message for 2008. Thank you for giving me the opportunity to be your SAPA president. I have thoroughly enjoyed it. There can't be enough said for all the members who cheerfully helped me during the year—too many to mention for fear of leaving someone out.

As the holidays approach, it is time to send you my wishes for a season filled with family and friends, and all good things in the New Year.

Jane Fohn , President

MEMBERSHIP REMINDER

Dues letters will have been mailed by the time you get your Philatex. Pay early and avoid the rush!

Dora Roberts, Membership Chairperson

Emergency Contact With Club Members

The recent possible visit by Hurricane Ike to San Antonio had the Board implement a way for quickly contacting club members in case a scheduled SAPA meeting had to be cancelled. The quickest way, of course, was by e-mail, supplemented by phone calls. We want to formalize the procedure for future use.

When the Board decides that a meeting may need to be cancelled, it will alert members with a mass e-mail. When a decision is made to cancel that meeting, a second mass e-mail will be sent. If there is no need to cancel the meeting, no further message will be sent after the initial alert. This will be spelled out in the alert message. Pat Richmond will be alerted by phone in case a sign is needed to be posted at the church door.

As for those members who do not use e-mail, or do not read it on a regular basis, and who regularly attend club meetings, please notify any Board member that you want to be on a telephone alert list. Depending on how many people opt for this means, the Board will decide on who will telephone them.

If you have not been contacted, or are unsure about the weather, you can call Jane Fohn at 566-1436, or Fred Groth at 829-0323. They are both in the 210 area code.

Those members who *do* use e-mail, please verify your address in the Philatex. If you are not in the Philatex, or have any changes, notify the editor, Lea Senghaas < lys@satx.rr.com >. She will notify everyone else.

SAPA Board of Governors

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UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

NOV 8-9 MID-CITIES STAMP EXPO 21st annual exhibition & bourse of the Mid-Cities Stamp Club at the Grapevine Convention Center, 1209 S Main St, Grapevine, Tx. Features exhibits, 27-dealer bourse, beginners' booth, giant mixture pick, silent auction, chance board, USPS substation, cacheted cover & show cancellation. Hours: Sat 10am-5pm, Sun 10am-4pm. Contact: Stanley Christmas, elvira6@swbell.net.

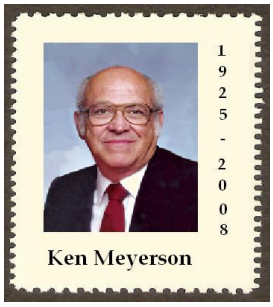
NOV 15-16 TSDA HOUSTON STAMP FAIR Bourse at the Ramada Plaza Hotel, 7611 Katy Frwy, Houston, Tx. Hours: Sat 10am-5pm, Sun 10am-4pm.

DEC 5-6 TSDA DALLAS STAMP FAIR *(Days have changed to Friday-Saturday)* Bourse at the Richardson Civic Center, 411 W. Arapaho Rd. (next to Richardson City Hall), Richardson, Tx. Hours: Fri 3pm-8pm, Sat 9am-4pm.

FEB 20-22 2009 AMERISTAMP EXPO/TEXPEX Annual winter exhibition & bourse of the American Philatelic Society at the Arlington Convention Center, 1200 Ballpark Way, Arlington, Tx, to be held in conjunction with TEXPEX. Show features APS World Series of Philately exhibits, and multiframe exhibits of Mexico in conjunction with the annual convention of the Mexico-Elmhurst Philatelic Society International (MEPSI), bourse (Over 100 dealers), beginners' booth, Harmer-Schau auction, cacheted cover & show cancellation. Many of the usual TEXPEX activities will be held at this show, including the 113th annual convention of the Texas Philatelic Association. Further details to come.

LONE STAR CHAPTER of the Èire Philatelic Association International meets 2nd Saturday between 2:00 PM and 4 PM every month in member's homes. Various aspects of Irish philately, and philately in general are discussed. All are welcome. For information call (210)658-9235.

CLOSED ALBUMS



Capt. Kenneth Mark Meyerson, USAF (Ret.) peacefully passed away on Saturday, September 13, 2008, in San Antonio. He was born in Brooklyn, NY, on April 16, 1925, and grew up in Miami Beach, FL, where he graduated from Miami Beach High School. He began his college career at the University of Miami. He was a charter member of Sigma Alpha Mu, and a member of the Golden Circle. He attended Trinity University in San Antonio, earning his Bachelor of Science Degree in 1949. He was a veteran of World War II, the Korean Conflict, and the Vietnam War as a navigator in the United States Air Force. After retiring from the military he returned to college at UTSA, earning a Master of Arts Degree in 1977. He then taught chemistry at Holmes High School for over 20 years before retiring in 1991.

He joined SAPA in 1971, Member #1992, and was a lifetime member of the American Philatelic Society.

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WEBSITE PHILATELY

http://www.japhila.cz/hof/exponet_menu.htm — The Czech website of international stamp exhibits.
http://www.stamps.org/cac/cac_arch.htm#20081 — APS Chapter Activities Committee (CAC) Newsletter
http://www.texasphilatelic.org — Texas Philatelic Association
http://www.stamps.org — American Philatelic Society
http://www.americantopicalassn.org — American Topical Association
http://www.precancel.com — The Precancel Stamp Society
http://www.usps.com/cpim/ftp/bulletin/pb.htm — USPS Postal Bulletin
http://www.foundationcenter.org/grantmaker/spungen/index.html — The Spungen Holocaust Postal Collection is a massive collection of Holocaust materials related to stamps, covers, postcards, letters, bank note forgeries, and manuscripts from concentration camps & Jewish ghettos.

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✯ ARCHIVOLOGY ✯

Holiday Snowflakes — # 4101-4104 — http://www.its.caltech.edu/~atomic/snowcrystals/stamps.htm

Snowflakes generally take one of seven basic forms. For example, stellar, or starlike, snowflakes usually grow six primary branches that support arms, which often develop thin plates of ice at the ends. Bitter-cold conditions create crystals with more facets. The most symmetrical snowflakes occur during light snowfalls when there is cold weather and little wind. If the air is warmer, crystals tend to stick together to form less symmetrical snowflakes, or they can take on a needlelike shape. In higher humidity, snowflakes may branch more, making them dendritic, or plantlike, in appearance.

The Holiday Snowflakes stamps are photographs of two basic snowflake patterns by physicist Kenneth Libbrecht. They are stellar dendrites, which form branching treelike arms, and sectored plates, which as their name suggests, form platelike arms. Because fallen snowflakes start to melt and lose their shape in mere minutes, Libbrecht quickly transferred the snowflakes from cardboard to a glass slide using a paintbrush. **He** then snapped the photos inside a temperature-regulated enclosure using a digital camera attached to a high-resolution microscope.

Falling from thousands of feet, these intricate ice crystals commonly begin as a piece of dust tumbling through the clouds. Gathering water molecules, they blossom into crystal forms in endlessly different patterns because of the constantly changing conditions of the atmosphere.

Christmas: Chacón Madonna and Child with Bird -- #4100

The 2006 Christmas stamp features an oil-on-canvas entitled Madonna and Child with Bird. Dating from around 1765, the painting is attributed to Ignacio Chacón-an artist active from about 1745 to 1775 in Cuzco, Peru. It is now part of the Engracia and Frank Barrows Freyer Collection of Peruvian colonial art at the Denver Art Museum. In designing the stamp, art director Michael Osborne slightly cropped the painting's floral "frame" and surrounded the entire composition with a gold border that echoes Chacón's use of gold-leaf embellishments.

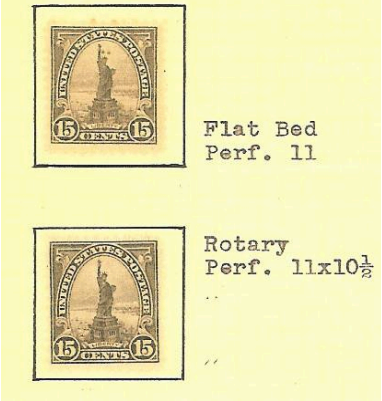
A famous painting by Spanish artist Bartolomé Esteban Murillo entitled La Sagrada Familia del Pajarito (The Holy Family of the Little Bird) probably served as an indirect prototype for Chacón's Madonna and Child with Bird. The importance of birds in Inca culture would have made the topic of Murillo's painting particularly resonant in Peru. Birds were sacred to the Inca, partially because of their ability to fly and move closer to Inti, the sun god. So in Cuzco, colonial artists often incorporated birds or feathers into images of the Virgin and Christ to indicate their divine status.

As many of you know, your membership chairman collects Christmas, Angels, & Madonnas on stamps, as well as many other things. When I was looking for something to put in this issue of our Philatex, I found these articles in the Dec '06 issue of the Huntsville Philatelic Club Newsletter. I hope you will enjoy my sharing them with you. — **Dora Roberts**

The original articles can be found at http://www.usps.com/communications/news/stamps/2005/sr05_054.htm — **Lea Senghaas**

Program Notes -August 22, 2008
"Statue of Liberty on World Wide Stamps" by Richard Spies

(A)



(B)

(D)

Richard has been collecting Statue of Liberty stamps World Wide for many years. In picture A, he is showing us the first U.S. Stamp showing the Statue of Liberty.

The first U.S. Liberty stamp (B)was issued Nov. 11, 1922 at Washington, D.C.. The design is from a photograph and drawing with a view of New York Harbor. The stamp was Flat Bed press printed. On August 1931, the stamp was rotary press printed.

After that, many foreign countries issued stamps honoring the Statue of Liberty. These countries include France, of course, Cuba, Panama, Brazil, Liberia, Peru, Uraguay, Philippines, Korea, San Marino, Bulgaria, China, Haiti, and Nicaragua.

In 1930, Spain issued a stamp (C) to commemorate the Spanish-American Union. It includes the Statue of Liberty and features Lindberg. It seems that "Patsy" (his pet cat and mascot pictured in the lower right-hand corner of the stamp) went with him on all his flights except the famous flight. Lindberg said," ...the trip was too dangerous to risk the life of a cat."

Richard's talk on his exhibit included several other philatelic items. One I found specifically interesting was a First Day Cover of a Panama stamp commemorating the 150th Anniversary of the American Constitution (E).

Richard polished off his exhibit with a pull-out of the Statue of Liberty (B) from an issue of History Channel Club magazine. It had many of the pertinent facts about the Statue of Liberty.

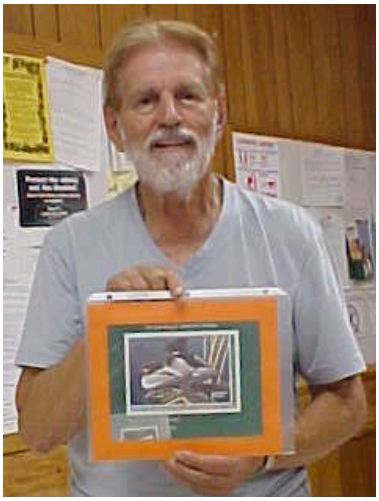
The program was all it was promised to be---enlightening and entertaining and was even within the time frame that we designed especially for Richard!!!!!! (In fact, he lacked a minute or two reaching the deadline—which he so graciously offered to fill for us---which invitation we very graciously declined!!!!)

Thank you, Richard for a very interesting program. We will be looking forward to your next treat!

Yours in Philately, Pat Richmond

(C)

(E)



Program Notes - Sept 19, '08
"Souvenir Cards" by Robert (Bob) Joyce

Bob started his program with a definition of a souvenir card.

"A souvenir card must meet the following 3 criteria: 1) They are momentos or souvenrs of a particular occasion, exposition, exhibition, person, place, etc; 2) They are usually examples of the finest printer's or engraver's art at that time; 3) Most are printed on high quality card-paper using intaglio techniques. A souvenir card is considered "official" if it is authorized and printed by a government printer. If it is printed by a printer involved in governmental printing but is not authorized by the government, it is considered "semi-official"—*Mellone's Photo Encyclopedia of Souvenir Cards* by Howard C. Tiffner, F.D.C. Publishing Co., Stewartsville, NJ, 2006, p.3.

Bob said his favorites were those called "fore-runners" they were smaller in size. One of his favorites (A) is the 1882 President James Abram Garfield Memorial.

These souvenir cards are printed in many countries. Bob had a nice sized album of United Nations souvenir cards that were very interesting and very colorful. He has Irish souvenir cards, also---go figure!!!!!

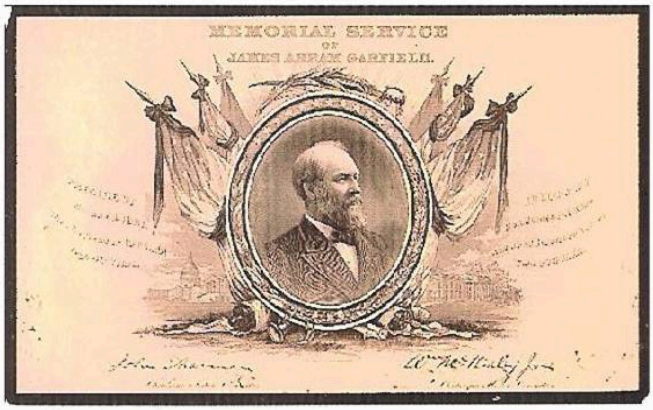
Bob had several bank note souvenir cards engraved by the American Bank Note Company. They were gorgeous.

One of his more modern favorites was one that commemorated Duck Stamps. If you buy the card, you get the stamp also. The following picture (B) is a close-up of the card that Bob is holding in the above picture. This card came out in 1994.

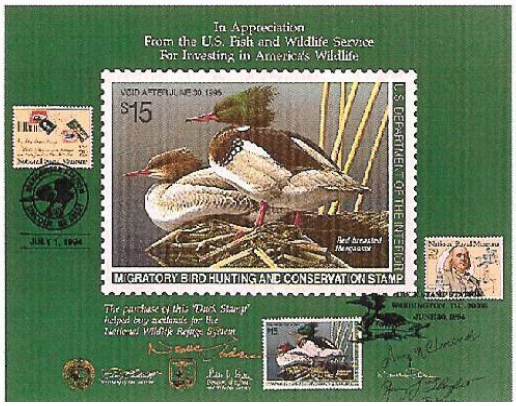
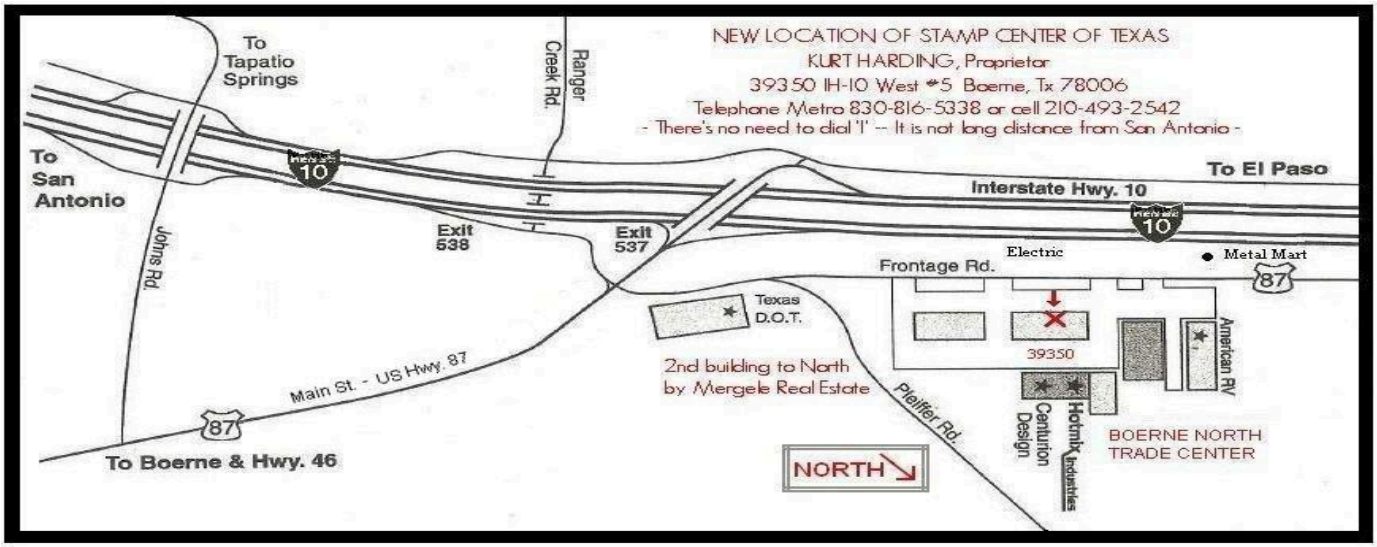
Collecting souvenir cards is expensive, but they are beautiful. It was quite an experience to see items that many people do not have ordinary opportunities to see.

Thank you, Bob for sharing your collection with us and giving us a whole new slant on philatelic collecting.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond



(A)



(B)